Md Nazmuzzaman Shifat

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Profile

Quantitative and mixed-methods research analyst with more than three years of applied research experience in education, human development, and public sector programs across Bangladesh and the United States. Skilled in literature reviews, survey and instrument design, coordination of field data collection in low-resource settings, and management and analysis of large quantitative and qualitative datasets using Stata, R, SPSS, Qualtrics, and Dedoose. Experienced in producing clear tables, figures, and narrative summaries for academic, practitioner, and policy audiences, and supporting grant-funded projects through data, writing, and coordination. Currently on STEM OPT work authorization in the United States and preparing for doctoral study in education policy and related fields.

Education

Harvard Graduate School of Education, Cambridge, MA — Sep 2023 – May 2024
Ed.M. in Education Policy and Analysis

- Nominee, Intellectual Contribution Award
- **Selected Quantitative & Methods Coursework:** Intermediate & Advanced Statistical Methods for Applied Educational Research (S052); Introductory & Intermediate Statistics for Educational Research – Applied Linear Regression (S040); Program Evaluation and Education Policy (A164); Research Synthesis and Meta-Analysis (S032A); Data in International Development (A830); Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems (ECON 50); Evaluation and Measurement in Education (PC-117); Methods and Techniques of Educational Research (ED-504).

University of Dhaka, Dhaka, Bangladesh — Jun 2020 – Mar 2022
Master of Education (Science, Mathematics and Technology Education)

- First class first; 1st Bangabandhu Scholar of Education and Development (Ministry of Education).
- **Thesis:** Exploring undergraduate students' concepts of Elasticity in Bangladesh (Grade: A+).
- **Selected Coursework:** STEM Curriculum Development; Trends and Issues in STEM Education; Innovation and Improvement in STEM Education; STEM Education and Human Resource Development; Research Methods.

University of Dhaka, Dhaka, Bangladesh — Jan 2015 – May 2020
Bachelor of Education (Hons.)

- First class first; Swargiya Anima Rani Saha Memorial Gold Medal, 2018.
- **Relevant Mathematics & Methods Coursework:** Multivariate Calculus; Differential Equations; Linear Algebra; Methods of Applied Mathematics; Educational Psychology; Instructional Technology; Research Methodology; Physics.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Professor Susan Dynarski — Jan 2024 – May 2024
Harvard Graduate School of Education – Cambridge, MA

- Developed a synthetic dataset and full replication module in **R** for a randomized controlled trial, supporting reproducible applied microeconometric research and teaching.
- Wrote, documented, and maintained analysis code; managed the project's **Git/GitHub** repository to facilitate collaboration, version control, and clear analytic documentation.

Research Assistant, Bangladesh Public Administration Project — Feb 2024 – May 2024
Ash Center for Democratic Governance, Harvard Kennedy School – Cambridge, MA

- Programmed and fielded a **Qualtrics** survey for senior civil service officials; coordinated with stakeholders to ensure timely and accurate data collection.
- Cleaned and managed electronically collected survey data; implemented quality assurance checks, constructed project databases, and prepared analysis-ready datasets.
- Produced descriptive statistics and summary tables in R/SPSS; contributed to written reports and presentation materials for internal and external audiences.

Early Career Researcher, 3MPower, The Open University, UK — Aug 2022 – Jan 2023
(EdTechHub-funded collaborative research project) – Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Conducted literature reviews and background research on EdTech-supported instruction for elementary mathematics teachers in low-resource settings.

- Assisted in the development of data collection instruments and training protocols; coordinated logistics for fieldwork with schools and teachers in rural and hard-to-reach communities.
- Received, merged, and managed quantitative and qualitative datasets; conducted data cleaning and quality checks; generated descriptive summaries and visualizations using **SPSS** and Dedoose.
- Co-authored reports and draft manuscripts summarizing findings for academic, practitioner, and donor audiences.

Research Associate, Institute of Education and Research Mar 2022 – Jun 2022
University of Dhaka – Dhaka, Bangladesh
Exploring Secondary Science Teachers' Creative Question Development and Evaluation

- Developed survey instruments; collected and coded data from secondary science teachers on assessment practices.
- Cleaned and analyzed quantitative data using **SPSS**; produced tables and figures; co-authored internal reports.

Research Associate, Institute of Education and Research Oct 2021 – Jun 2022
University of Dhaka – Dhaka, Bangladesh
Students' Learning Gap during Covid-19 Pandemic: Friendship's Experience in Char Islands and the Way Forward

- Collected survey and interview data in marginalised river-island communities; ensured adherence to ethical protocols and data quality standards.
- Managed mixed-methods datasets; conducted quantitative analyses in **SPSS** and contributed to drafting policy-oriented reports on learning loss and recovery strategies.

Research Associate, Institute of Education and Research Jan 2018 – Jun 2020
University of Dhaka – Dhaka, Bangladesh
A Tracer Study for Matching Diploma in Engineering Curriculum for Local and Global Employability

- Contributed to instrument design and data collection planning for one of Bangladesh's largest mixed-methods tracer studies in technical and vocational education.
- Developed and maintained project databases; merged multi-wave survey datasets from graduates and employers; carried out data entry checks, recoding, and consistency checks in **SPSS**.
- Conducted descriptive and multivariate analyses; created tables and figures; and supported the writing of reports used to inform national curriculum revisions.

Project Management and Consultancy Experience

Project Associate, Bangladesh Public Administration Project Jun 2024 – Aug 2024
Ash Center for Democratic Governance, Harvard Kennedy School – Cambridge, MA

- Coordinated a multi-day professional development program for senior civil service officials, managing agendas, session schedules, participant communications, and on-site logistics.
- Served as liaison among Harvard project teams, client government agencies, and other stakeholders, ensuring timely information flow and smooth program delivery.
- Supported grant-funded project administration, including documentation, tracking activities against timelines, and assisting with travel and expense processes.

Content Development Consultant, Agami Education Foundation – Dhaka, Bangladesh Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

- Evaluated and refined science and mathematics lessons and content for the *Life is Fun* project, designed to foster underprivileged children's interest in STEM.
- Collaborated with educators and project staff to ensure materials were pedagogically sound and feasible to implement in low-resource classroom settings.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Fellow, Harvard University – Cambridge, MA Sep 2024 – Present
Harvard Graduate School of Education, Harvard Extension School, Harvard Summer School

- Support graduate and advanced undergraduate courses including: *Using Economic Models to Understand Education Systems (A205)*; *Using Evidence to Improve Teaching and Learning (BA840)*; *Intermediate Statistics for Educational Research: Applied Linear Regression (EDU S030)*; *Introductory and Intermediate Statistics for Educational Research (EDU S040)*; *Intro to Quantitative Methods for the Social Sciences and Humanities (STAT E100)*; *Analytical Methods in Sustainability (ENVR E210)*; *Education Policy Analysis and Research in Comparative Perspective (BA801)*; *Neuroscience of Learning: An Introduction to Mind, Brain, Health and Education (PSYC S1609)*; *Intercultural and Global Competence (SSCI S-188)*; *Nationalism: Historical Roots and Contemporary Effects (SOCI S-165)*.

- Lead discussion sections and problem-solving sessions; hold office hours; grade quantitative problem sets and policy memos; support students in interpreting empirical research and applying statistical concepts.
- Coordinate course logistics across multiple courses, including scheduling, room and AV/IT arrangements, preparation and distribution of readings and assignments, and communication with faculty, guest speakers, and students.

Lecturer, Department of Educational Technology Jan 2023 – Aug 2023
Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Digital University – Bangladesh

- Taught courses on Educational Research and Data Analysis and Introduction to Education
- Led workshops and training sessions on assessment, measurement, and teaching methods; provided ongoing feedback and support to teachers on classroom implementation.
- Wrote a successful grant proposal and secured a BDT 150,000 grant from the University Grants Commission (UGC) and led the research project, and contributed to curriculum review as a member of the Bachelor of Education Technology curriculum committee.

Lecturer (Adjunct), Prime University – Dhaka, Bangladesh Oct 2022 – Jan 2023

- Taught graduate-level courses on Advanced Educational Measurement and Evaluation and Advanced Teaching Methods and Techniques to in-service and pre-service teachers.
- Guided practicing teachers in refining instructional strategies, assessment design, and classroom implementation through assignments, presentations, and feedback.

Publications

Shifat, M. N., & Claude, M. (2024). Beyond SDG4: Reimagining the sustainable development goals for a better future. In *Quality education for all for a better world: Learning from the sustainable development goals* (Vol. 2). Independently Published.

Shifat, M. N., Claude, M., & Clarebout, H. (2024). The declining trend in finland's PISA reading scores: The way forward. In F. M. Reimers, J. Chia, P. Choudhury, S. Heng, N. Nguyen, & W. Warren (Eds.), *Education policy analysis to make the world better* (p. 330, Vol. 2). Independently Published.

Conference Proceedings

Shifat, M. N. (2024). Higher education admission policies in bangladesh: Enabling upward mobility or reinforcing inequalities? In S. Smith (Ed.), *Equitable higher education in times of disruption (proceedings of the 2024 wes-cihe summer institute)* (pp. 27–29). Center for International Higher Education, Boston College. https://drive.google.com/file/d/14CwXwx7ZIT7GylhkSu-ixVyta-AOPGjR/view

Technical Skills and Methods

- **Statistical Software:** Stata; R; SPSS.
- **Survey & Data Tools:** Qualtrics; Dedoose for qualitative data; experience building and maintaining project databases.
- **Data Tasks:** Literature reviews; instrument and protocol development; cleaning and merging datasets; descriptive and basic inferential analysis; preparation of clear tables, figures, and narrative summaries for reports and publications.
- **Office & Collaboration Tools:** Microsoft Excel, Word, PowerPoint; Git/GitHub; experience coordinating with diverse stakeholders across institutions and sites.
- **Languages:** English (fluent); Bangla (native).